

ZAIRA CHRISTA BARAKAT

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PROFILE

Oxford-educated strategist completing an MA in Cultural and Creative Industries at King's College London, with a research-led approach built on close analysis, structured argument, and evidence-based decision-making. Directed an independent fashion label from concept to catwalk, managing contracts, stakeholder negotiations, and commercial risk at each stage; and drove a threefold increase in ticket sales for Oxford's flagship fashion event through data-informed strategy. Combines hands-on operational leadership, structured analysis and confident stakeholder communication across creative, commercial and frontline settings.

EDUCATION

King's College London – MA Cultural and Creative Industries	2025 - 2026
University of Oxford, Somerville College – BA (Hons) Music, 2:1	2022 - 2025

EXPERIENCE

Zaira Christa Fashion Label <i>Founder and Creative Director</i>	London 2022 - Present
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- Founded an independent fashion label and brought two seasonal collections from initial concept through to runway presentation, directing all creative, production, and styling decisions independently.
- Built the label's brand identity across digital platforms, producing a portfolio of campaign imagery and editorial content that articulates a distinct creative point of view.

The Reach Brasserie <i>Bar Manager</i>	London 2025 - Present
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- Managed day-to-day bar operations in a high-footfall venue, maintaining consistent brand standards across service, supplier relationships, and staff performance.
- Designed and launched a curated seasonal cocktail offering, balancing creative concept development with cost efficiency and commercial viability.

Oxford Fashion Gala <i>Co-Creative Director & Co-Marketing Director</i>	Oxford 2023 - 2025
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- Appointed to lead the end-to-end creative vision for Oxford's largest annual fashion event, producing a thematically unified show by directing concept development, casting direction, set design, and choreography from brief to live performance.
- Drove a 200% increase in ticket sales year-on-year by designing and executing a multi-platform social campaign that combined curated content, strategic collaborations, and a data-informed posting schedule.
- Delivered a cohesive campaign identity aligned with the Gala's creative vision, coordinating all audience-facing assets, copy, and promotional content across a team of volunteers.

Levi Strauss <i>Stylist</i>	London 2025
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- Exceeded sales targets during Black Friday, one of retail's highest-pressure trading periods, by delivering personalised styling consultations that increased units per transaction (UPT) above the team benchmark.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Tokyo Drift - Cultural Ethnography	Tokyo 2025
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- Produced a 10,000-word ethnography from three weeks of Tokyo fieldwork using participant observation, formal and semi-structured interviews, fieldnotes, and reflective journaling; analysed how sound, fashion, and movement shape subcultural identity.

Bekaa - Hospitality Brand Strategy	Independent MA 2026
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- Combined cultural, competitor, and market research with audience definition, operational planning, and financial planning to develop positioning and recommendations for a differentiated listening-bar concept.

SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES

Languages: English (fluent), French (working proficiency), Arabic - Lebanese dialect (intermediate)

Transferable Skills: Team leadership, project management, cross-functional collaboration, client-facing communication, budget awareness

Tools: Microsoft Office, PowerPoint, applied AI, Notion

Research & analysis: Stakeholder interviews, ethnography, user research, market and competitor research, structured synthesis, financial planning